Mekhel Powell

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SUMMARY

Georgia Tech M.S. Cybersecurity candidate with hands-on enterprise experience triaging endpoint telemetry via SentinelOne Singularity XDR and Red Canary. Experienced in preparing CMMC compliance documentation and building Power BI/Power Automate pipelines to streamline AI tool procurement workflows. Brings a strong foundation in enterprise networking concepts, Linux/Windows virtualization, and practical lab work in threat analysis, vulnerability assessment, and security automation.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology — Expected December 2026

M.S Cybersecurity, Cybersecurity and Privacy — GPA: 3.71

Georgia State University — Fall 2021-Summer 2025

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Honors College — GPA: 3.72

SKILLS

- Cybersecurity Tools & Platforms: Wireshark, Docker, VMWare, Ghidra, Red Canary, Sentinel One Singularity XDR, Power BI, Power Automate
- Programming & Scripting: Python, C/C++, PowerShell, Java, React
- Operating Systems & Environments: Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, Debian), Windows (Server and Enterprise)

WORK EXPERIENCE

YKK Corporation of America — Atlanta, GA

Cybersecurity Intern — Jan 2025 - Apr 2025

- Utilized SentinelOne Singularity XDR and Red Canary to monitor and triage endpoint telemetry across the YKK Americas enterprise, managing high-volume alert traffic and ensuring all critical threats were escalated for immediate incident response.
- Strengthened regional security posture by preparing system documentation for CMMC compliance assessments and engineering automated Power BI and Power Automate workflows to streamline enterprise AI tool procurement and review tracking.

Georgia Tech – Bridge UP STEM Program — Atlanta, GA

Student Assistant — Summer 2025

- Facilitated technical STEM workshops for 30+ high school students, providing advanced Python troubleshooting and debugging support during hands-on coding sessions.
- Mentored high school students on cybersecurity career pathways and technical fundamentals, translating complex computing concepts into actionable learning objectives

Georgia State University – Upward Bound Program — Atlanta, GA

Tutor-Counselor — Summer 2022 – Dec 2024

- Instructed high school students in fundamental Computer Science and mathematics, simplifying complex technical concepts to foster student engagement and academic success.
- Provided long-term technical mentorship to 100+ students, simplifying computer science and mathematical concepts to foster academic growth and increase engagement in STEM disciplines

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Cloud Threat Deception and SIEM Telemetry — Independent Project

Detection Engineering & Cloud Security — Fall 2026

- Deployed an AWS EC2 Cowrie SSH honeypot using iptables redirection, streaming JSON telemetry over mTLS to a Wazuh SIEM cluster for real-time brute-force and command execution analysis.
- Authored custom XML detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK (T1078, T1046), enriched attacker coordinates via GeoIP pipelines, and audited host posture against CIS Ubuntu Benchmarks.

Phishing Email Detection System — Atlanta, GA

Network Security – Georgia State University — Spring 2025

- Engineered a Python-based classifier achieving 96.8% accuracy in detecting malicious patterns, including look-alike domains, suspicious header metadata, and urgent NLP-based sentiment, using Scikit-learn and feature engineering
- Developed a React interface to process 1,000+ live email samples against real-world datasets, providing a user-accessible dashboard that translates backend detection logic into actionable risk scores.

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

- Information Security Lab: Malware & Threat Analysis, Software Security (Fuzzing/SRE), Web and Mobile Security
- Secure Computer Systems: Trusted Computing Base, Access Control Mechanisms, Distributed System Security.
- Info Security Strategies & Policy: Risk Management, CMMC/Regulatory Frameworks, International Cyber Policy.
- Data Privacy and Law: Privacy technology, IAPP Privacy by Design, Information Security Strategies and Policies